

# Civil Services (Main) Qualifying English - Paper B

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 300

## INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory except that only one essay topic is to be attempted.
2. Write all answers in English and observe the indicated word limits.
3. Marks in this qualifying paper are not counted for merit ranking.

## Q1. Essay [100 marks]

Write about 600 words on any one topic.

1. Rules gain legitimacy when they are understandable as well as enforceable.
2. The ability to listen is a form of public responsibility.
3. Progress should enlarge human judgment, not merely human choice.
4. A city is made not only by buildings but by shared habits.

## Q2. Comprehension [75 marks]

Public discussion of data often begins with collection: how many records an institution holds and what patterns a computer can detect. Collection is only the first step. Facts become useful when they are accurate, interpreted carefully and connected to a decision for which someone is responsible. A correct record can still answer the wrong question. Attendance does not establish learning, clinic visits do not prove recovery and average traffic speed may hide danger to pedestrians. Numbers simplify reality so that it can be compared; they should not replace the reality they simplify. Good use of data requires judgment about what a measure excludes and what behaviour a target may encourage. This does not justify abandoning measurement. Without records, failure remains invisible and claims cannot be tested. Institutions should combine numerical evidence with observation, explanation and a route for correction. They should publish enough information for scrutiny and revise a measure when it begins to conceal the problem it was designed to reveal.

1. What conditions make collected facts useful?
2. How can a correct record answer the wrong question?
3. What does it mean to say that numbers may replace reality?
4. Is the author opposed to measurement? Give reasons.
5. Give a suitable title and identify the author's tone.

## Q3. Precis Writing [75 marks]

Write a precis in about one-third of the passage. Do not give a title.

Silence is often treated as the absence of communication, but in public life it may signify agreement, fear, confusion or exclusion. A chairperson who invites comments and receives none cannot assume that everyone has been heard. Participants may lack technical language, fear disagreeing with a superior or believe that the decision is already final. A formal opportunity to speak is therefore not identical with a fair opportunity to influence an outcome. Listening demands more than waiting politely. It requires asking whether the question was clear, whether relevant people were present, whether another format would permit candour and whether minority reasons were recorded. These steps may slow a decision but prevent avoidable misunderstanding. Listening also has limits: no institution can postpone action until disagreement disappears, and emergencies may require speed. The aim is not unanimity but the distinction between informed acceptance and silence produced by fear, confusion or exclusion. A public body can then decide firmly while remaining open to correction.

## Q4. Usage and Vocabulary [50 marks]

### A. Correct the sentences

1. The list of candidates are displayed.

2. She has lived here since five years.
3. He insisted to inspect the file.
4. Neither Rohan nor his friends was ready.
5. I prefer walking than driving.

### **B. Supply the missing preposition or word**

1. intended \_\_\_\_
2. familiar \_\_\_\_
3. based \_\_\_\_
4. accused \_\_\_\_
5. different \_\_\_\_

### **C. Use the correct verb form**

1. If the train \_\_\_\_ (leave), we will wait.
2. She \_\_\_\_ (prepare) when they arrived.
3. By next June, they \_\_\_\_ (complete) it.
4. Neither answer \_\_\_\_ (seem) sound.
5. I \_\_\_\_ (not see) him since Monday.

### **D. Choose the correct word**

1. elicit/illicit
2. exceed/accede
3. credible/credulous
4. affect/effect
5. together/altogether

END OF PAPER